encapsulates the need for even more thoughtful research to fully explicate the issues raised by Sai Deepak.

Sai Deepak's involvement in historic cases—such as the Sabarimala Ayyappa Temple case—as a Supreme Court advocate, serves as the trigger for his book because they underline the critical issue of the historical consciousness of Bharatiyas evident in how they were presented, argued and received by the Supreme Court. The apparent dichotomy counterposed between tradition and the rationality of modernity by those involved on opposing sides exposed the parameters of the key intellectual conundrum analysed by Sai Deepak, namely coloniality and the distorted consciousness, by and large, of the Bharatiya society. Such perceptual distortions arose from the unconscious and largely unquestioning acceptance of ideas of modernity that came to dominate intellectual life in the nineteenth century and accepted as valid by both colonisers and the colonised. The argument advanced in the book is the exact obverse of the accusation of 'false religion' levelled by Christian evangelists against Hindus. What Sai Deepak seeks to unravel is the mystique and veil of coloniality itself that has profoundly shaped the thinking of the conquered by white European Christian subjugation since the advent of Christopher Columbus in 1492 ce.

A key intellectual and political conviction of the argument in the Latin American decoloniality literature, revisited in Sai Deepak's tract, is the overpowering nature of colonial consciousness and the distinctive self-serving mindset of the coloniser as well. It first locates the origins of the colonial experience at the dawn of the religiously and racially inspired Age of Discovery rather than the subsequent era of the Enlightenment that preoccupies postcolonial analysts, firmly establishing its underlying Christian ideological rationalisation. The decoloniality episteme rejects the unspoken foundational intellectual assumptions of modernity that are, in effect, also subliminally universalised within the very postmodernist and postcolonial critiques of the colonial and imperialist postures of European modernity. In effect, the decolonial framework seeks to reinscribe the primacy of indigeneity, indigenous consciousness and its subjectivity in formerly colonised societies and civilisations.

One of the fundamental questions examined in the book is the rootedness of the entire colonial venture in Christian conceptions derived from Biblical verities. However, what is very rarely understood is the chameleon